

FOR THE FRIDGE, THE DESK, THE CO-OP WALL

Our family AI rules

1

Grown-ups hold the keyboard.

Chatbots are built for ages 13+. Kids watch, ask, and decide with us — we type.

2

AI guesses; it doesn't know.

We check important things somewhere real before we believe them.

3

Our names and photos stay ours.

No names, faces, addresses, or family stories go into AI tools. Ever.

4

AI helps us think — it doesn't think for us.

Drafts and ideas are fine. Your work, your words, your decisions.

5

We talk about the weird stuff.

If AI says something confusing, wrong, or upsetting, we bring it to each other. Nobody's in trouble.

_____ kid signature

_____ grown-up signature

THE ONE-MINUTE VERSION FOR THE BACK OF THE POSTER

Why these five rules, and how to talk about them

Signing a poster together beats a lecture. Go rule by rule, ask "when might this one matter?", and let your kids give the examples — they'll surprise you. Here's the thinking behind each rule, in words that hold up to follow-up questions.

- **1 · Grown-ups hold the keyboard.** This isn't our rule — it's the tools' rule (13+), and pediatricians agree. Framing it like the deep end of the pool keeps it about readiness, not punishment: "not yet" instead of "never."
- **2 · AI guesses.** The single most useful thing a child can know about AI. It predicts likely words; it states wrong things confidently. "Let's check" is the habit that makes every future AI tool safer for them.
- **3 · Our names stay ours.** Whatever goes into a free AI tool may be stored beyond your control. Model it out loud: "I'm asking about *a seven-year-old who loves dinosaurs* — the AI doesn't need to know it's you."
- **4 · AI doesn't think for us.** The homework-and-beyond rule. Using AI to brainstorm or check is a skill; pasting its words as your own is skipping the learning. Your work, your words.
- **5 · We talk about the weird stuff.** The safety net under everything. Kids who expect a calm conversation report the strange thing; kids who expect trouble hide it.

Make it stick

Post it where screens live. Revisit when something changes — a new tool at school, a birthday near 13, a sibling old enough to ask. Re-sign each school year; the re-signing conversation is the real product.

Want the lesson that goes with it? Our free unplugged "What Is AI?" kitchen-table lesson (ages 4–8) teaches rules 1, 2, and 4 through three games — and the Homeschool AI Planning Pack puts AI to work on the grown-up side. Both in our TpT store.